

Nikos Pagonas

Contact

Email: nikospagonas00@gmail.com — Website: nikpag.github.io

Education

Columbia University

PhD in Computer Science

Advisor: Prof. [Kostis Kaffes](#)

GPA: 3.94/4.00

Member of [DAPLab](#), focusing on improving the performance and efficiency of agentic serving. I build systems that exploit workflow structure and runtime characteristics to optimize model routing, scheduling, and resource allocation.

Sep 2024 – Present

New York, NY, US

National Technical University of Athens (NTUA)

Master of Electrical and Computer Engineering

Advisors: Prof. [Nikos Vasilakis](#), Prof. [Georgios Goumas](#)

GPA: 9.39/10.00 (14th out of 344 students)

Thesis: “*SPLASH: Scaling Out Shell Scripts on Serverless Platforms*”

Oct 2018 – Jun 2024

Athens, Greece

Experience

Google

Student Researcher

Supervisor: Prof. [Arvind Krishnamurthy](#)

Designed and implemented [Cortex](#), a prototype agentic serving platform that leverages workflow-awareness and stage isolation to improve scheduling and KV cache efficiency in agentic NL2SQL workflows.

May 2025 – Aug 2025

Sunnyvale, CA, US

Brown University

Student Researcher

Advisor: Prof. [Nikos Vasilakis](#)

Contributed to [PASH](#), an open-source [Linux Foundation](#) project. Worked on improving the performance of shell scripts by running them on serverless infrastructure, and providing fault tolerance for distributed shell script execution.

Sep 2023 – May 2024

Providence, RI, US

Arrikto Inc.

Software Engineering Intern

Supervisor: [Vangelis Koukis](#)

Explored how to serve PyTorch models more efficiently through KServe, a highly scalable machine learning deployment platform for Kubernetes.

Dec 2022 – Mar 2023

Athens, Greece

Awards	Columbia University Presidential Fellowship	2024 – Present
	A.G. Leventis Foundation Scholarship	2025 – Present
	Gerondelis Foundation Scholarship	2025
	ACM SOSP 2025 Student Travel Grant	2025
Publications	AgentOpt v0.1 Technical Report: Client-Side Optimization for LLM-Based Agents Wenyue Hua, Sripad Karne, Qian Xie, Armaan Agrawal, Nikos Pagonas, Kostis Kaffes, Tianyi Peng	
	VineLM: Trie-Based Fine-Grained Control for Agentic Workflows Nikos Pagonas, Matthew Lou, Tianyi Peng, Dan Rubenstein, Kostis Kaffes	
	Cortex: Workflow-Aware Resource Pooling and Scheduling for Agentic Serving Nikos Pagonas, Yeounoh Chung, Kostis Kaffes, Arvind Krishnamurthy <i>SOSP 2025 Workshop on Systems for Agentic AI (SAA 2025)</i>	
	leash: Scaling Out Shell Scripts with Reliable Cloud Computing <i>(Under Submission)</i>	
Service	EuroSys 2026	2026
	Artifact Evaluation Committee	
	SOSP 2025	2025
	<i>Artifact Evaluation Committee</i>	
	OSDI 2025	2025
	Artifact Evaluation Committee	
Teaching	ATC 2025	2025
	Artifact Evaluation Committee	
	EuroSec 2024	2024
	Web and Publication Chair	
	Columbia University	Fall 2025
	<i>Teaching Assistant</i> Course: Networks, Crowds, and the Web Professor: Augustin Chaintreau	New York, NY, US
	Columbia University	Spring 2025
	<i>Teaching Assistant</i> Course: Agentic Systems Made Real Professors: Eugene Wu , Kostis Kaffes	New York, NY, US

Brown University Fall 2024
Teaching Assistant Providence, RI, US
Course: [Systems Transforming Systems](#)
Professor: [Nikos Vasilakis](#)
Guided students through a systems research project, including implementation, evaluation, and paper writing. Paper submitted to USENIX ATC 2025.

Brown University Spring 2024
Teaching Assistant Providence, RI, US
Course: [Distributed Systems](#)
Professor: [Nikos Vasilakis](#)
Helped revamp the course by redesigning its semester-long project and implementing its autograding infrastructure from scratch.

National Technical University of Athens Spring 2022
Lab Assistant Athens, Greece
Course: Operating Systems
Professors: [N. Koziris](#), [G. Goumas](#)

National Technical University of Athens Spring 2020
Lab Assistant Athens, Greece
Course: Programming Techniques
Professors: [N. Papaspyrou](#), [A. Pagourtzis](#), [G. Stamou](#), [G. Goumas](#)

National Technical University of Athens Fall 2019
Lab Assistant Athens, Greece
Course: Introduction to Programming
Professors: [N. Papaspyrou](#), [D. Fotakis](#), [S. Zachos](#)

Research Mentoring	Grace Li Sep 2025 – Present <i>Columbia University, BS in CS and Math</i>
	Matthew Lou Sep 2025 – Present <i>Columbia University, BS in CS and Applied Math</i>
	Joey Huang Sep 2025 – Dec 2025 <i>Columbia University, BS in CS</i>

Skills	Prog. Languages	Python, C, Shell, Javascript, Java, Go
	Frameworks	LangChain, LangGraph
	Platforms	AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, Apache Kafka, Apache Spark
	Tools	Git, LaTeX

Languages	English	Fluent — TOEFL iBT 116/120 (C2)
	Greek	Native